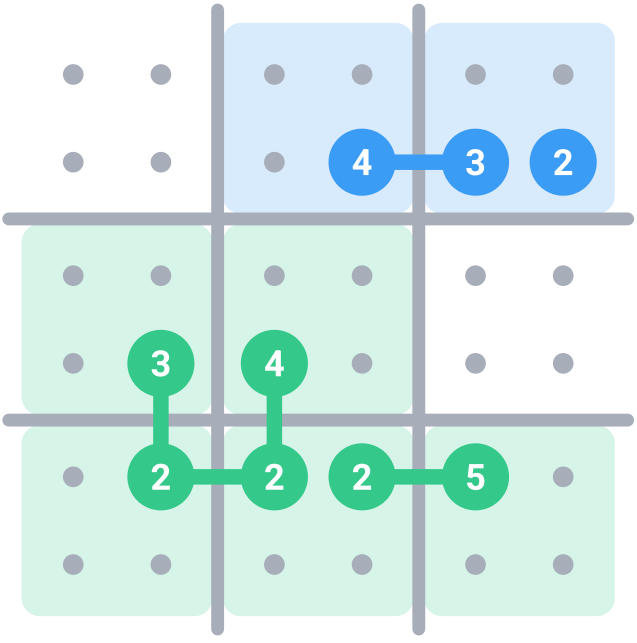
Province

A strategy game of bridges and borders

How to play | 2 players | 6×6 and 8×8 boards | free, in your browser



province-game.com

Contents

Got a specific question? Tap a title to jump straight to it. Every move has its own section with examples of what is allowed and what is not.

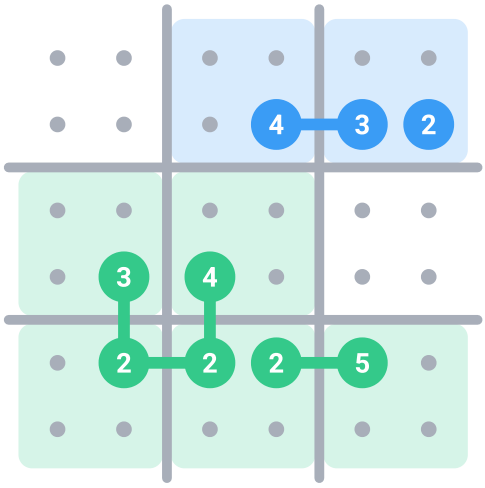
1 The goal
2 What you have
3 Your turn: roll, re-roll, pass
4 The lit squares: what can I do?
5 Land: new soldiers
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7 Attack
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10 Build a bridge
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1 The goal

Be the first to control **5 connected provinces** (**8** on the big board).

Rivers split the board into **provinces**: blocks of 2×2 squares (9 provinces on the 6×6 board, 16 on the 8×8 board). You **control** a province when **only you** have soldiers in it. If both colours are inside, **nobody** controls it.

The provinces you control must be **connected**. Every province is separated from the next by a river, and a river can only be crossed on a bridge, so your provinces are joined by **your bridges**. Loose provinces do not count.



Green controls the 5 shaded provinces on the left and bottom, joined by green bridges: that is a win.

Blue holds only two provinces in the top corner.

The win is checked at the **end of every turn**: whoever has the connected provinces at the end of **their own** turn wins.

2 What you have

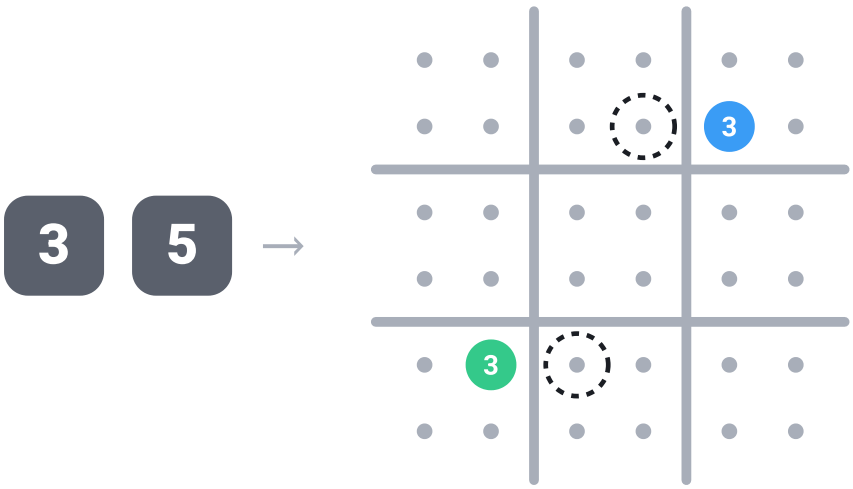
	6×6 BOARD	8×8 BOARD
Provinces	9	16
Soldiers each	36	54
Bridges each	8	14
Dice	1 to 6	1 to 8
To win	5 connected provinces	8 connected provinces

- A **base** is a square with your soldiers on it.
- Your **camp** holds the soldiers that are not on the board. New soldiers come from the camp.
- Soldiers that die are gone for good (the **graveyard**). They never come back.

Bridges are limited. You get a fixed number for the **whole game**, and every bridge you build uses one of them for good. The counter next to the arch icon shows how many you have left.

3 Your turn: roll, re-roll, pass

1. **Roll the dice.** The two numbers light up **two squares**, on opposite sides of the board. You will play on **one** of them.
2. **Re-roll if you want.** Once per turn you may throw the dice again. The new roll **replaces** the old one, so you cannot go back to the first squares.
3. **Make one move** on a lit square (sections 5 to 10).
4. The turn passes to your opponent.



The numbers on the dice point to **two squares** (dashed rings), one on each side of the board. You pick one of them.

No legal move? If the lit squares give you nothing to do, tap **Re-roll**. If the new roll gives nothing either, tap **Pass** and the turn goes to your opponent. The Pass button appears only after you have used your re-roll.

One turn is **one move**: one action, on one lit square. You never get two actions in a turn.

4 The lit squares: what can I do?

What you may do depends on **where the lit square is**. Look at it first.

WHERE THE LIT SQUARE IS	WHAT YOU MAY DO
Inside your territory: your own base, an empty square of a province you control, or any square joined to them by your bridges	**Land** on it (it is yours or empty). **Move** or **attack** from **any base** of that territory. **Withdraw** from any base of that territory. **Transport** from any base of that territory. **Build a bridge** from any base of that territory.
Outside your territory, but touching one of your bases	**Land** on it, only if it is empty and not enemy territory. **Move** or **attack** onto it, from a base that touches it. **Build a bridge** onto it, from a base that touches it. No withdraw, no transport.
Anywhere else (not yours, and none of your bases touches it)	**Land** on it, only if it is empty and not enemy territory. Nothing else.
An enemy base, or an empty square inside enemy territory, and none of your bases touches it	**Nothing.** If both lit squares are like this you have no legal move: re-roll.

The one rule people forget: new soldiers (landing and reinforcing) go **only on the lit square**. Having a big territory does **not** let you reinforce any base you like. Section 5 shows exactly what is allowed.

"Your territory" is explained in section 12. In short: your bases plus the squares of provinces you control, joined by your bridges.

5 Land: new soldiers

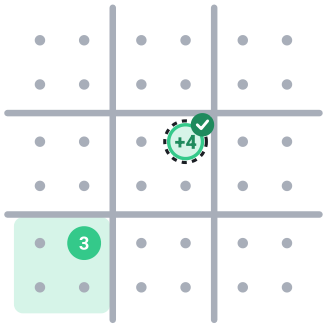
Bring soldiers from your camp onto the board. Landing on one of your own bases is also how you **reinforce** it.

WHEN	The lit square is **empty** (and not enemy territory), or it is **one of your bases**.
WHERE	**Only on the lit square.** Never on another base of yours, never next to it.
HOW MANY	Any number from 1 up to everything in your camp.
RESULT	The soldiers stand on the lit square. If it was empty, a new base appears.

Allowed

✓ ALLOWED

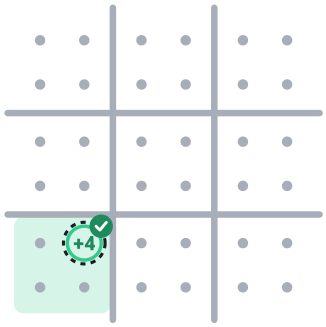
An empty lit square



The lit square is empty: land soldiers from your camp right on it. A new base appears.

✓ ALLOWED

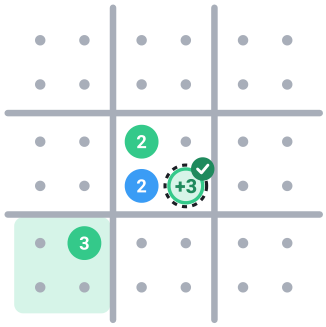
Your own base



The lit square is one of your bases: add soldiers from your camp to it.

✓ ALLOWED

Next to an enemy base

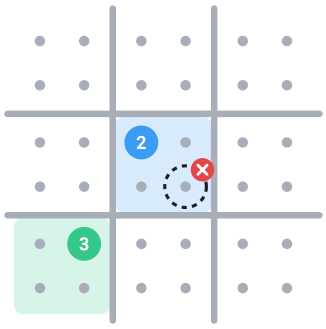


Both colours are in this province, so nobody controls it. Its empty squares are not enemy territory, and you may land here.

Not allowed

✕ NOT ALLOWED

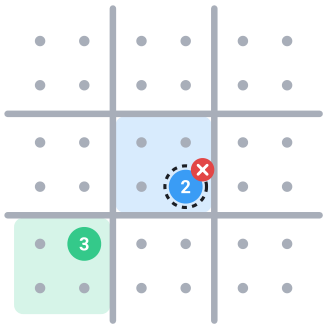
Inside enemy territory



Blue controls this province, so all of its squares are Blue territory, even the empty ones. No landing.

✕ NOT ALLOWED

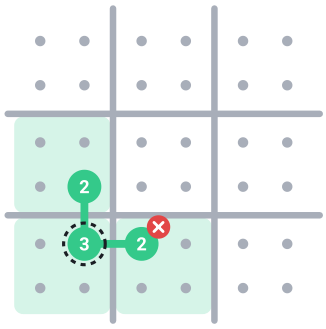
An enemy base



You cannot land on top of enemy soldiers. Attack them instead (see Attack).

✕ NOT ALLOWED

A different base of yours



Only the lit square gets new soldiers. The lit base (dashed ring) can be reinforced, but your other bases cannot, even though they are in the same territory.

6 Move

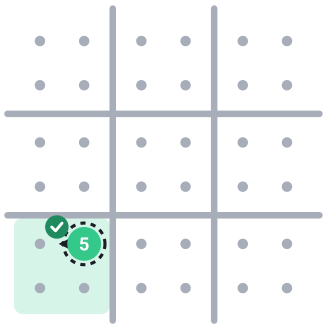
Take soldiers from one of your bases and put them on a square next to it.

WHEN	Any lit square from which you can reach a start base (section 4): a lit square in your territory, or a lit square touching one of your bases.
FROM	Lit square in your territory: **any base** of that territory (and any base touching the lit square). Lit square outside your territory: only the bases that **touch** it.
TO	A square that **shares a side** with the start base (up, down, left or right). From a base of your territory this can be **any** neighbouring square. From a base outside your territory it can only be the lit square.
HOW MANY	Any number from 1 up to all the soldiers of that base. Moving all of them leaves the square empty.
RIVERS	Across a river you need a bridge. One of yours is free to use. With no bridge, the move builds yours (it uses one from your supply). You cannot use an enemy bridge.
RESULT	The soldiers join the target square (an empty square, or one of your bases). If it holds enemy soldiers, the move is an **attack** (section 7).

Allowed

✓ ALLOWED

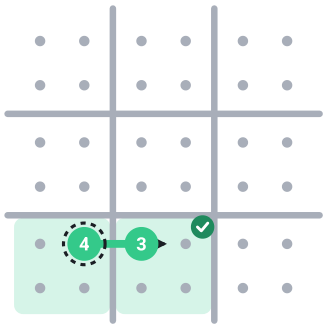
To a square next to the base



Move any number of soldiers (1 to all of them) from a base to a square that shares a side with it.

✓ ALLOWED

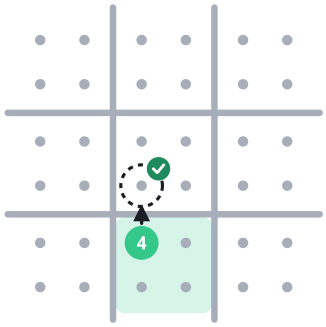
From any base in your territory



The lit square is in your territory, so you may play from ANY base of that territory. Here the soldiers that move are not on the lit square.

✓ ALLOWED

Onto a lit square next to your base

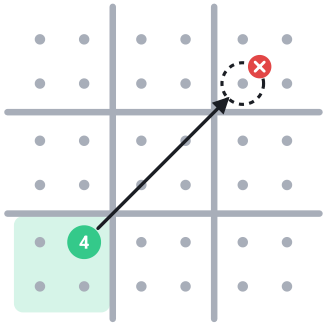


The lit square is outside your territory but next to your base: move there from that base. Crossing the river builds your bridge.

Not allowed

✕ NOT ALLOWED

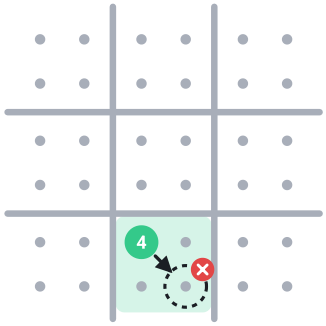
A lit square far from your bases



The lit square is not in your territory and none of your bases touches it. You cannot move there.

✕ NOT ALLOWED

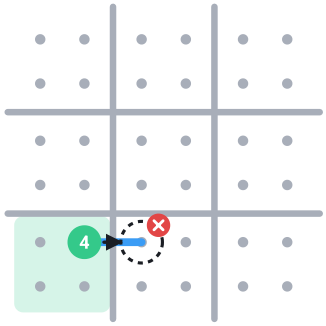
Diagonally



Squares touch only when they share a side: up, down, left or right. A diagonal does not count.

✕ NOT ALLOWED

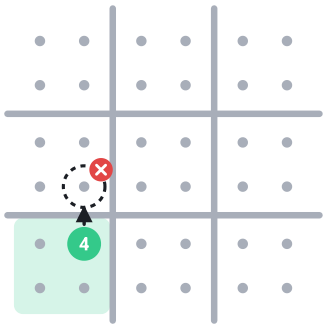
Across an enemy bridge



A bridge belongs to whoever built it. You cannot cross Blue's bridge (you can only replace it, see Build a bridge).

✕ NOT ALLOWED

No bridges left



Crossing a river with no bridge needs a new one. With none left in your supply you cannot cross.

7 Attack

An attack is a move onto a square that holds **enemy soldiers**. It follows every rule of Move (section 6): same start bases, same neighbouring squares, same river rules.

HOW IT ENDS	Each attacker kills **one** defender.
DEFENDERS	The ones that are killed are **gone for good**.
ATTACKERS	All the attackers leave their base. Those that killed are **worn out** and go back to your camp. Attackers beyond the number of defenders **stay** on the captured square.

ATTACKERS VS DEFENDERS	RESULT
5 vs 3	3 defenders die. 2 attackers stay and the square is yours (3 return to camp).
3 vs 3	All 3 defenders die. The square is left **empty**. Your 3 attackers return to camp.
2 vs 5	2 defenders die, 3 defenders remain. Your 2 attackers return to camp.

Across a river the attack also uses a bridge, exactly like a move: one of yours is free, with no bridge it builds yours.

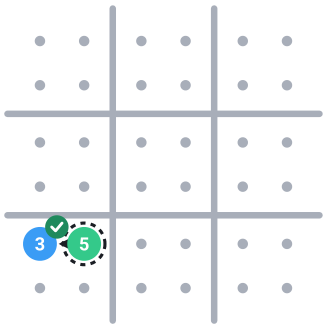
5 attack ⚔ 3 defend → 2 stay on the square

3 worn-out attackers **go back to camp**.
3 defenders are **dead for good**.

Allowed

✓ ALLOWED

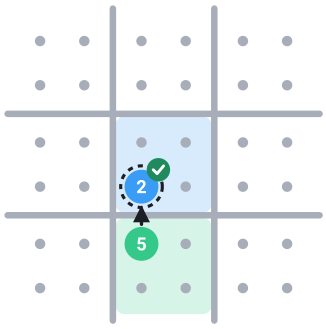
A base next to yours



5 attackers against 3 defenders: 3 defenders die, 2 attackers stay on the square, 3 attackers are worn out and go back to your camp.

✓ ALLOWED

Across a river

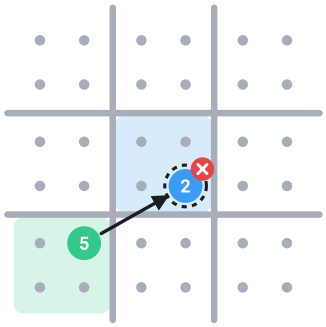


You can attack across a river. The attack builds your bridge, as part of the same move.

Not allowed

✕ NOT ALLOWED

A base that is not next to yours



You can only attack a square that touches the base you attack from.

8 Withdraw

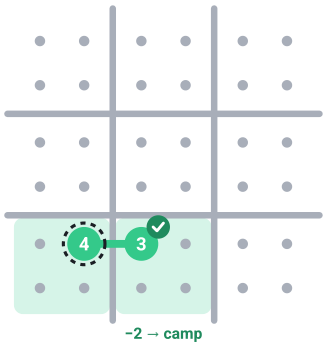
Pull soldiers off the board and back into your camp.

WHEN	Only when the lit square is **inside your territory**.
FROM	**Any base** of that territory.
HOW MANY	Any number from 1 up to all the soldiers of that base. If you take them all, the base disappears.
WHY	To save soldiers from a position you cannot defend, or to have more soldiers in camp to land later.

Allowed

✓ ALLOWED

From any base in your territory

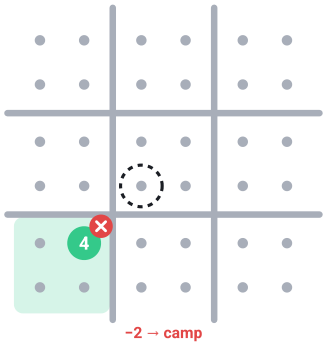


The lit square is in your territory: take any number of soldiers off ANY of its bases and back to your camp.

Not allowed

✕ NOT ALLOWED

A lit square outside your territory



Withdrawing needs a lit square inside your territory. This one is outside, even though it touches your base.

9 Transport

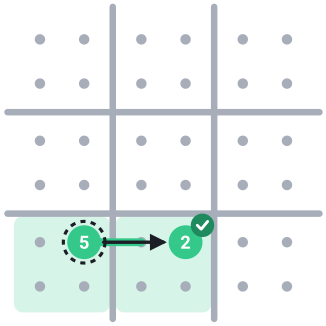
Send soldiers from one of your bases far along a straight line, inside your territory, in a single move.

WHEN	Only when the lit square is **inside your territory**.
FROM	**Any base** of that territory.
THE LINE	Straight along a row or a column, **any distance**. It may only pass through your own territory: your bases and the empty squares of provinces you control. An enemy base or a square outside your territory stops it. A river can be crossed only on **your own bridge**.
TO	Any square of your territory along the line: one of your bases, or an empty square of a province you control (a new base appears).
HOW MANY	Any number from 1 up to all the soldiers of the start base. They **all** go to the **same** destination: no splitting.

Allowed

✓ ALLOWED

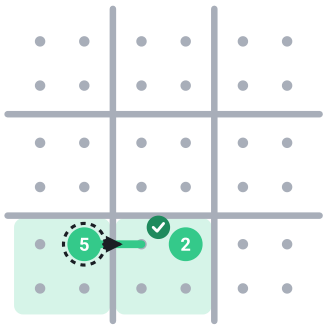
Along a straight line to a base



In a straight line through your territory (here over your bridge), as far as you like, in one move.

✓ ALLOWED

To an empty square of your province

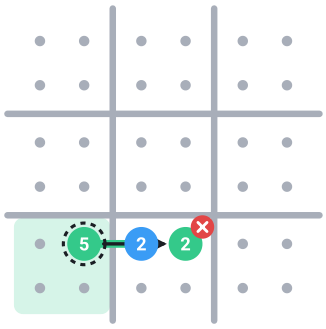


The empty squares of provinces you control are part of your territory. Transport can end on one of them, and a new base appears there.

Not allowed

NOT ALLOWED

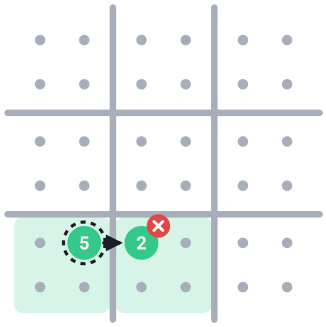
Blocked by an enemy base



The line may only pass through your own territory. An enemy base stops it, so you cannot jump over it.

NOT ALLOWED

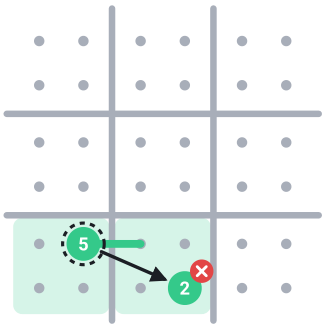
Over a river with no bridge of yours



A river can be crossed only on a bridge that you built. (A normal move would build one; transport does not.)

NOT ALLOWED

Not in a straight line



Only straight lines: along a row or along a column. No turns and no diagonals.

10 Build a bridge

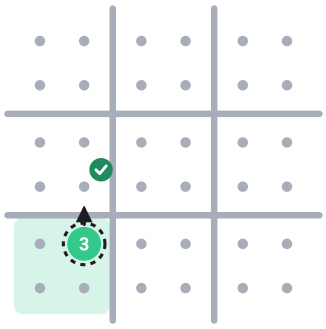
Place one of your bridges across a river. You can do it **on its own**, or **together with a move**: building a bridge and moving soldiers over it is **one move**, never two turns.

WHEN	Like Move: the lit square is in your territory, or touches one of your bases.
WHERE	Between one of your bases and the **square across the river** from it (the square can be empty, yours, or the enemy's).
COST	One bridge from your supply, for good.
SOLDIERS	**None** (a bridge only), or any number from 1 up to all of them (a move or attack across the new bridge).
REPLACE	If an **enemy bridge** already connects the two squares and you hold **both ends** with your soldiers, you may replace it with yours. The enemy bridge disappears.

Allowed

✓ ALLOWED

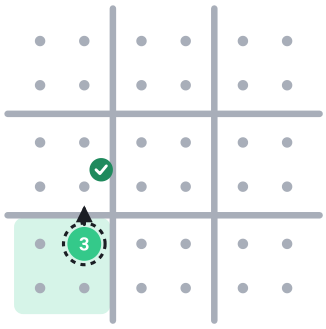
A bridge and nothing else



Build a bridge from your base across the river without moving any soldier.

✓ ALLOWED

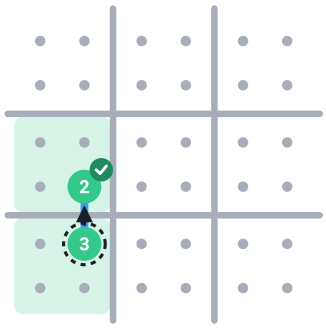
Build the bridge and move over it



A bridge and a move are ONE move, not two. Crossing a river with soldiers builds the bridge as part of it.

✓ ALLOWED

Replace an enemy bridge

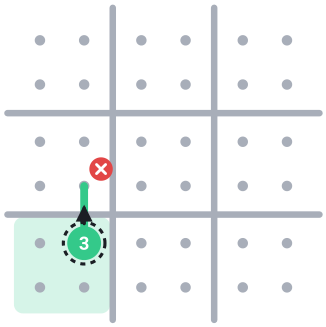


Blue's bridge is replaced by yours, because you hold the squares at both ends.

Not allowed

✕ NOT ALLOWED

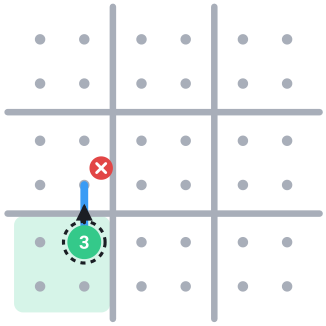
A bridge is already there



There is already a bridge of yours between these squares.

✕ NOT ALLOWED

An enemy bridge, only one end yours

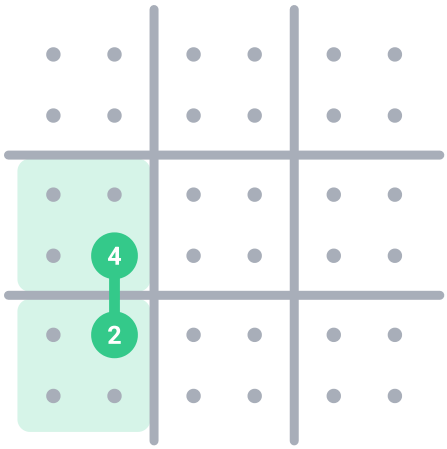


To replace an enemy bridge you need soldiers on both squares it connects.

11 Rivers and bridges: the rules

- A square next to a river is separated from the square across it. To go across (move, attack, bridge, transport) you need a **bridge**.
- A bridge belongs to the player who built it. **Only its owner can cross it.**
- **Your bridge:** you cross it freely and for free.
- **No bridge:** a move or attack across the river builds yours (it uses one from your supply). Transport cannot build one.
- **Enemy bridge:** you cannot cross it. The only thing you can do is replace it, when you hold both ends (section 10).

- **Out of bridges:** with none left in your supply you cannot cross a river unless a bridge of yours is already there.
- There is at most **one** bridge between two squares.



A green bridge joins the two squares across the river. Green crosses it freely. Blue cannot.

Why bridges matter: your provinces are connected only through **your** bridges. A bridge is what turns a few provinces into a winning chain, and replacing the enemy's bridge can cut his chain.

12 Provinces and territory

Controlling a province

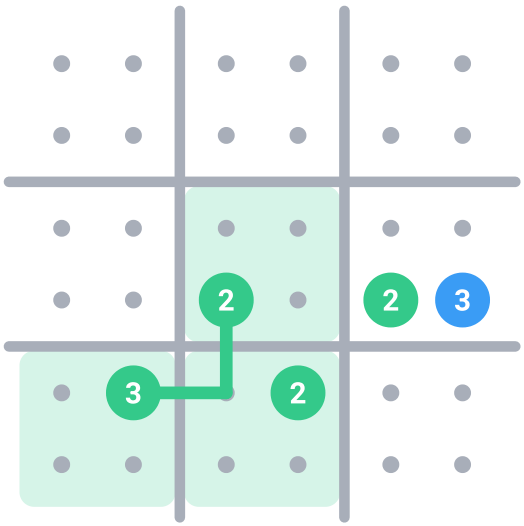
A province is **yours** when the soldiers inside it are all yours. It is **the enemy's** when they are all his. If both colours have soldiers in it, **nobody** controls it. An empty province belongs to nobody.

Your territory

Your **territory** is made of:

- all your **bases**, and
- all the squares of every province **you control**, even the empty ones,

joined together when squares touch, or when they are on two sides of a river that has **your bridge**. Two pieces separated by a river with no bridge of yours are two separate territories.



○ **Shaded**: provinces green controls. All their squares, even the empty ones, are green territory.

The three green provinces are joined by green bridges: one territory.

The province at the right holds both colours: nobody controls it, so its squares are **not** territory. Green's base there is a base, but it is cut off from the rest.

What the territory does for you

- A lit square in your territory lets you **move, attack, withdraw, transport and build bridges from any base of it**.
- Transport runs through it.
- In a province both of you are in, the squares are **not** territory for either of you. That is why you may land there, but cannot transport through it.
- You can **never land** in **enemy** territory.

13 Winning, and common questions

You win at the end of your own turn if you control 5 provinces (8 on the big board) that are connected in one territory.

QUESTION	ANSWER
Can I reinforce any base in my territory?	No. New soldiers go only on the lit square (section 5).
Can I play on both lit squares?	No. One move per turn, on one of the two squares.
Can I land next to enemy soldiers?	Yes, if the lit square is empty and not inside enemy territory (a province that holds both colours is fine).
Can I move soldiers from a base that is not on the lit square?	Yes, if the lit square is in your territory: any base of it (section 4).
Do I have to move all the soldiers of a base?	No. Any number from 1 to all of them.
What happens to a base when all its soldiers leave?	It disappears: the square becomes empty.
Can I skip my turn?	Only with Pass, which appears after you have used your re-roll.
Do attackers die?	No. They are worn out and go back to your camp. Only defenders die for good.
I have no bridges left. Am I stuck?	Not completely: you can still cross on bridges of yours that are already built, and play inside a river-bounded area.
Can the enemy cross my bridge?	No. Only the owner can. He can only replace it if he holds both ends.